

ScriptLens — 30-day retention playbook (cohort model)

Use this for **closed waves of 3–5 writers**, ~7 days of primary access, then a **30-day follow-through** so founding users don't vanish after the demo week.

Goals

Days 1–7	Uploaded a real script + ran ≥ 1 simulate
Days 8–14	Marked ≥ 1 finding useful or ran a second pass
Days 15–30	Returned for a rewrite checkpoint or said when they'll rewrite next

Capacity rule: one active cohort at a time; keep concurrent editors $\leq \sim 5$.

0. Before Wave Day 0

Waitlist → invite filter (ask these)

1. Fountain, PDF, or both?
2. Typical script length (short / feature)?
3. Next rewrite window (this week / this month / later)?
4. OK with a timed access window?

Invite people with a **rewrite in the next 2–4 weeks** first — they retain better.

Cohort ops checklist

- ☐ VPS healthy (2 GB preferred); restart API before the wave
- ☐ Founding offer decided (e.g. \$19–29/mo locked 3 months)
- ☐ Feedback form live (link below)
- ☐ Calendar: Wave start, mid-check (Day 3), close (Day 7), Day 14, Day 30
- ☐ Personal Slack/email thread for the 5 writers (optional but high leverage)

Feedback form (same every wave)

1. Did you finish upload → simulate on a real script? (Y/N)
 2. Which finding was most useful? (orphan / cut risk / other / none)
 3. Did you trust it? (1–5)
 4. What broke or confused you?
 5. Would you pay? Range: \$0 / \$15 / \$29 / \$49 / \$99+
 6. When is your next rewrite?
 7. One sentence: why you'd come back — or why not
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1. Email sequence (copy/paste)

Replace bracketed fields. Keep subject lines short.

E0 — Invite (Day -2 or Day 0 morning)

Subject: You're in ScriptLens Wave {{WAVE}} ({{START}}-{{END}})

Hi {{NAME}},

You're in the next ScriptLens writer cohort ({{START}} → {{END}}).

Access: {{APP_URL}}

Your window: {{START}}-{{END}} (then we rotate the next set — you can still get founding access after).

In one sitting (~15 min): 1. Upload a script you're actually rewriting (Fountain preferred; clean text PDF OK) 2. Open one high-risk / orphan finding 3. Run **Simulate** on a cut or edit you'd consider in real life 4. Reply to this email with: "useful / wrong / unclear" + scene number

Founding note: If Wave {{WAVE}} is useful, you can lock **{{FOUNDING_PRICE}}/mo for 3 months** before public pricing.

Questions → reply here. I'm reading every note this week.

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E1 — Kickoff (Day 0, when access opens)

Subject: Wave {{WAVE}} is open — one real script today

Hi {{NAME}},

Access is live: {{APP_URL}}

Ignore the tour. Do this today:

1. Upload **your** script (not a toy)
2. Click the finding that feels most dangerous
3. Simulate one cut/edit
4. Thumb / reply: useful or off?

If PDF looks wrong, try Fountain or see the cleanup guide we sent. If the session expires, just re-upload — early builds keep sessions in memory.

Form (2 min) whenever you've tried once: {{FEEDBACK_FORM}}

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E2 — Day 3 check-in (personal; send individually)

Subject: Quick check — Scene {{SCENE}} still the risky one?

Hi {{NAME}},

Checking in on Wave {{WAVE}}.

Have you had a chance to simulate on {{SCRIPT_OR_“your draft”}} yet?

If yes: which finding felt right, and which felt wrong?

If not: what's in the way — time, file format, or trust?

No essay needed — three lines is perfect.

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E3 — Day 7 wave close + founding offer

Subject: Wave {{WAVE}} closing — founding lock + next rewrite

Hi {{NAME}},

Wave {{WAVE}} primary access wraps **{{END}}**. Thank you for the real-script testing.

Two asks: 1. Feedback form if you haven't: **{{FEEDBACK_FORM}}** 2. When is your **next rewrite**? (date or "sometime in {{MONTH}}")

Founding offer (optional):

Stay on ScriptLens at **{{FOUNDING_PRICE}}/mo for 3 months**, cancel anytime. I'll ping you when that rewrite week hits so you're not starting from zero.

Reply **FOUNDING** if you want the lock, or **LATER** if you only want a rewrite reminder.

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E4 — Day 14 (only if they activated; skip if never uploaded)

Subject: Second pass? Or save it for the rewrite

Hi {{NAME}},

It's been a week since Wave {{WAVE}}.

Writers get the most from ScriptLens on a **second pass** — after you've changed an act break, cut a scene, or moved a reveal.

- If you're mid-rewrite: re-upload and simulate the cut you're debating
- If not yet: tell me the week you expect to rewrite and I'll nudge you then

Link: **{{APP_URL}}**

Still founding-eligible through **{{FOUNDING_DEADLINE}}**: reply **FOUNDING**

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E5 — Day 14 (never activated)

Subject: No stress — want a 20-min walkthrough?

Hi {{NAME}},

Looks like Wave {{WAVE}} got buried (happens).

Want either: - **A**) a 20-min screenshare on *your* script, or
- **B**) a slot in Wave {{NEXT_WAVE}}

Reply A or B. No guilt either way.

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E6 — Day 30 rewrite nudge

Subject: Rewrite checkpoint — **{{SCRIPT_TITLE_OR_“your script”}}**

Hi {{NAME}},

You flagged a rewrite around now (or it's been ~30 days).

Checkpoint: 1. Re-upload the current draft
2. Simulate the cut/edit you're least sure about
3. Reply with one line: kept / changed / ignored the suggestion

{{APP_URL}}

If the timing slipped, send a new date — I'll move the reminder.

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

E7 — Cancel / pause (when someone says they're out)

Subject: Pausing is fine — one question

Hi {{NAME}},

Totally fine to pause.

For my notes (one line): was it **trust**, **workflow** (not in your daily tools), **timing**, **price**, or **bugs**?

If it's timing, I'll leave you alone until {{OPTIONAL_DATE}}.

If it's bugs/trust, I want the scene number — that's gold.

— {{YOUR_NAME}}

2. In-app prompts (ship when you can; fake with email until then)

Use short copy. One job per prompt. No badge spam.

P1 — First landing (empty state)

Headline: Upload a script you're actually rewriting

Body: Fountain works best. Clean text PDF is OK. You'll get structure risk + simulate — not a grade.

CTA: Upload script

Secondary: Have a messy PDF? Open cleanup tips

P2 — Right after first analysis completes

Headline: Pick the finding you'd argue about with a producer

Body: Start with high-risk or orphan. Then simulate a cut/edit you'd really consider.

CTA: Review top finding

Microcopy under list: Wrong? Tell us — it trains what we fix next.

P3 — On each finding (orphan / cut risk)

Title line: Why this fired (one sentence from engine)

Actions:

- Useful
- Wrong
- Unclear

After Useful: "Simulate this?"

After Wrong: "Thanks — optional: what's wrong?" (short text)

P4 — Before first simulate (if they only browsed)

Headline: Simulation is the point

Body: Preview what breaks if you cut or edit a scene — before you do it in Final Draft.

CTA: Simulate a cut

P5 — After first simulate

Headline: Save this decision for your rewrite

Body: Early builds may lose sessions on restart. Screenshot or note Scene {{ID}} + what you'd cut.

CTA: Run another simulate

Secondary: Send feedback (2 min)

(When accounts exist, replace with: "Saved to your project — resume anytime.")

P6 — Session expired / re-upload

Headline: Session expired — your file isn't gone from your machine

Body: Re-upload the same draft to continue. We're adding saved projects next.

CTA: Re-upload

P7 — Limited structure / bad PDF parse

Headline: We couldn't fully trust this layout

Body: Orphans and cut risk may be unreliable. Try Fountain or a cleaner text PDF before you decide cuts.

CTA: Upload Fountain

Secondary: Cleanup guide

P8 — Analysis busy (queue / 503)

Headline: Another script is analysing

Body: This machine runs a small writer lab — try again in a minute.

CTA: Retry

(Later: "You're in queue — ~N min")

P9 — Day 3 equivalent (return visit, no simulate yet)

Headline: You haven't simulated yet

Body: Browse-only rarely changes a draft. Pick one cut you'd consider and preview the blast radius.

CTA: Simulate now

P10 — Return visit after ≥ 1 simulate (second session)

Headline: Second pass?

Body: Re-upload after act-break / scene-cut changes. That's when ScriptLens usually earns its keep.

CTA: Upload new draft

P11 — Founding banner (Days 5–14, cohort only)

Banner: Wave {{WAVE}} founding: {{FOUNDING_PRICE}}/mo for 3 months

CTA: I want founding

Dismiss: Not now

P12 — Cancel flow (when billing exists)

Step 1: Pause for 1 month instead of cancel?

Step 2: Reason: trust / workflow / price / bugs / timing

Step 3: If bugs/trust → "Which scene?"

Close: "We'll nudge at your next rewrite date" if timing

3. 30-day calendar (one cohort)

-2	Email E0	Invite
0	Email E1 + P1	Kickoff
0-2	In-app P2-P5	Drive first simulate
3	Email E2	Personal check-in
5-7	In-app P11	Founding banner
7	Email E3	Close wave + founding + next rewrite date

14	Email E4 or E5	Second pass or walkthrough offer
Rewrite date or 30	Email E6	Checkpoint
Anytime exit	Email E7 + P12	Pause / learn reason

Your daily ops (15 min): reply to every Useful/Wrong note; log bugs; don't invite Wave N+1 until top crash is fixed.

4. Metrics to log per wave (spreadsheet is enough)

	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N		Y/N		Y/N	Y/N	

Wave health

- Activation rate = Simulated ÷ Invited (*aim ≥ 60%*)
- Trust signal = Useful≥1 ÷ Simulated (*aim ≥ 40%*)
- Founding conversion = Founding ÷ Activated (*bonus*)
- Day-30 return = back for rewrite ÷ Activated (*aim ≥ 30% early*)

If activation < 40%: fix onboarding/PDF, don't buy ads.

If useful < 25%: fix false positives before growing cohorts.

5. Merge fields cheat sheet

{{ WAVE }}	B
{{ START }} / {{ END }}	10 Mar / 16 Mar
{{ APP_URL }}	https://app.yoursite.com
{{ FEEDBACK_FORM }}	Google Form link
{{ FOUNDING_PRICE }}	\$29
{{ FOUNDING_DEADLINE }}	23 Mar
{{ NEXT_WAVE }}	C
{{ YOUR_NAME }}	Subhi

6. What not to do

- Don't email "We miss you" with no script-specific hook
- Don't invite the next 5 while the current 5 are still crashing
- Don't promise always-on multi-user until sessions persist (Postgres/Redis)

- Don't add five CTAs on first paint — upload → one finding → simulate